

Deputy Special Educational Needs Coordinator (Primary) (Deputy SENCo)

The Deputy SENCo supports the strategic and operational delivery of SEND provision across the academy. Working closely with the SENCo and wider inclusion team, the post-holder plays a vital role in ensuring that pupils with additional needs receive high-quality, timely, and effective support. This is a hands-on role that combines administrative leadership, pupil-focused interventions, and professional collaboration with staff, families, and external partners. The Deputy SENCo also supports the continuous development of inclusive practices across the academy.

Core Purpose

- Provide high-quality administrative and operational support to the SENCo, ensuring the effective day-to-day running of the SEND provision.
- Contribute to the inclusive culture of the primary academy by supporting the delivery of provision for pupils with SEND.
- Support staff, parents, and external agencies in matters related to SEND, fostering a collaborative and welcoming environment.
- Ensure that internal systems, pupil records, and statutory documentation are accurate, up to date, and fully compliant with legal requirements.
- Uphold the values and ethos of the primary academy, promoting best practice in equality, diversity, and inclusion.

Key Responsibilities

1. Day-to-Day Operations

- Oversee the efficient administrative functioning of the SEND provision, including procedures, records, and digital systems.
- Provide general administrative support (e.g., document creation, report generation, filing, photocopying).
- Manage incoming communications and enquiries from parents, staff, and external organisations, ensuring timely and professional responses.
- Ensure that all pupil records and tracking systems are accurate and regularly updated.
- Maintain legal and compliant filing systems for all SEND documentation (both electronic and physical records).
- Coordinate drop-in sessions, referrals, and external communications to support pupil needs.
- Lead the maintenance and updating of provision maps and one-page profiles across the primary academy.

- Conduct meetings with parents, contribute to Annual Reviews, and facilitate teacher meetings related to pupils' individual needs.
- Mentor new Teaching Assistants, supporting their induction and development within the team.
- Manage the Speech and Language Therapy (SALT) provision, including referrals and communications with the SALT team, staff, and families.
- Plan and deliver training sessions to staff, covering key areas of need and individual pupil strategies (via CPD sessions, INSET, or briefings).
- Provide a warm, professional welcome to all visitors to the SEND provision.

2. Management Information and Reporting

- Generate and analyse data from school systems to support planning, interventions, and statutory reviews.
- Assist with the production and quality assurance of statutory paperwork, including Annual Reviews and Personal Education Plans (PEPs).
- Liaise with external agencies to ensure appropriate and timely information sharing.

3. Professional Collaboration and Conduct

- Work flexibly and collaboratively with the SENCo, wider inclusion team, and classroom staff.
- Contribute to staff training and professional development initiatives linked to SEND.
- Ensure that all activities are conducted in line with academy policies and values, including the consistent application of equality and diversity principles.
- Participate in relevant training and development opportunities to enhance skills and knowledge in SEND and inclusion.

4. Other Responsibilities

- Contribute to the wider life of the academy as a proactive and positive member of staff.
- Carry out any additional duties reasonably requested by the SENCO or senior leadership to support the effective operation of the SEND provision.
- Maintain confidentiality and handle sensitive information with discretion and professionalism.

Person Specification – Deputy SENCO (Primary)

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes expected for the role of Deputy Special Educational Needs Coordinator (Deputy SENCo) in a primary academy setting.

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Degree in a relevant subject area.
- Qualified Teacher Status (QTS), recognised by the Department for Education.
- Evidence of ongoing professional development in safeguarding or related areas.

Desirable:

- Willingness to complete the NASENCo qualification.
- Further training in specific areas such as ASD, SEMH, or communication needs.

Experience

Essential:

- Proven impact on improving outcomes for pupils with SEND.
- Experience supporting SEND pupils in a primary school setting.
- Experience of working with external professionals and families to support pupils.
- Confidence in analysing data to inform provision.

Desirable:

- Experience of managing or mentoring colleagues in an educational setting.
- Involvement in statutory processes such as Annual Reviews or EHCPs.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Knowledge of safeguarding legislation and responsibilities.
- Commitment to inclusive education and equal opportunities.

- Understanding of the SEND Code of Practice and relevant statutory guidance.
- Knowledge of a range of SEND (e.g. learning difficulties, SEMH, ASD).
- Familiarity with legal and procedural frameworks that underpin SEND practice.

Desirable:

- Understanding of the needs of Looked After Children (LAC) and SEND pupils.
- Awareness of differentiated teaching strategies for diverse learning needs.
- Knowledge of effective behaviour management approaches for pupils with SEND.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Highly organised with a methodical and accurate approach to work.
- Ability to work both independently and collaboratively within a team.
- Strong problem-solving and time management skills, including the ability to multitask under pressure.
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills for engaging with staff, parents, and professionals.
- Ability to produce high-quality written documentation, including reports and correspondence.
- Confident use of digital tools including the Google Suite and data tracking platforms.
- Proficient in statistical reporting and the use of information systems to support SEND monitoring in a primary setting.

Personal Qualities and Attributes

The successful candidate will be a **highly organised and methodical individual**, with a passionate commitment to inclusive education in a primary setting. They will demonstrate **excellent communication and interpersonal skills**, enabling them to build **strong relationships** with staff, parents, and external professionals. The Deputy SENCo will be both **proactive and collaborative**, capable of **working independently** and as **part of a team**. They will possess **resilience** and **adaptability** under pressure. Above all, they will be dedicated to ensuring the best possible outcomes for pupils with SEND in a primary setting.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) ([Department of Education](#)).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.